

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 238

By Jones J

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Bad Idea, named one of the best restaurants in the country.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should recognize those exemplary small businesses that, through their unwavering commitment to excellence, are a credit to this State; and

WHEREAS, one such notable establishment is Bad Idea in East Nashville, which was selected by *The New York Times* as one of fifty restaurants on its definitive Restaurant List for 2024, which recognizes the best restaurants across the country, and included on *USA TODAY's* 2025 Restaurants of the Year list; and

WHEREAS, located inside what was once a church building at 1021 Russell Street, Bad Idea is a wine bar that specializes in envelope-pushing Lao food; the concept was brought to life in 2023 by Alex Burch, a seasoned sommelier and first-time restaurateur; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Burch brought on as executive chef Colby Rasavong, who grew up working in his Laotian family's Thai restaurant and formerly served as the top lieutenant to Sean Brock; he is noted as investing "the weight of his life experience in food that stretches the boundaries of Southeast Asian cooking to the edge of Appalachia"; and

WHEREAS, the menu opens with shareable starters like nam khao croquettes served with jeow mak len (a Lao tomato dipping sauce) before segueing into scallop-stuffed crepes with nam prik blanquette and Anson Mills broken rice porridge served with egg, wild mushrooms, and ginger; and

WHEREAS, larger format dishes include a bucksnort trout served with turmeric crepes, Bear Creek pork collar with scallion crepes, and chicken served two ways, featuring khao piak (wet rice noodles) prepared with local Proper Sake udon and pickled dark meat and a serving of chicken rice with fold-in crispy skin and chicken fat; and

WHEREAS, with his extensive wine background, Alex Burch decided to focus Bad Idea around a wine program that celebrates variety in style, origin, and availability; the wine list offers at least three dozen wines by the glass and more than 100 bottles, including a variety of Madeiras, Champagnes, ciders, beers, and classic cocktails, and a selection that features spicy food-friendly rieslings, exceptional skin-contact wines, an interesting collection of pinot noirs, and a couple of big Napa Valley cabs; and

WHEREAS, the design of the restaurant is perhaps as impactful as what it serves; longtime developer Mark Sanders of East Nashville purchased and then renovated the 19,000-square-foot church and former YMCA after it was severely damaged in a tornado; Bad Idea occupies more than 5,000 square feet of space, with twenty-five-foot curved ceilings and tall windows that welcome in the fading light as the sun sets; and

WHEREAS, interiors were handled by local studio Design Object and feature a sprawling horseshoe bar in the middle of the dining room, emphasizing comfortable lounge and bar seating; the church's original windows and soaring ceilings were left intact and lend the light-filled space a sense of ethereal elegance, while a stained-glass fixture over the bar and pew-like dining banquettes nod to the space's former life as a house of worship; and

WHEREAS, in addition to recognition from *The New York Times* and *USA TODAY*, Bad Idea has garnered praise and accolades from *Wine Enthusiast*, *Eater Nashville*, *The Tennessean*, *The Infatuation*, *Bon Appétit*, *Robb Report*, *Nashville Business Journal*, *Style Blueprint*, *Nashville Lifestyles*, *Nashville Post*, and *NASHtoday*; and

WHEREAS, Bad Idea is a fantastic recent addition to Nashville's ever-growing culinary landscape, and we are most fortunate and proud that this restaurant calls Tennessee home; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE

CONCURRING, that we honor and commend proprietor Alex Burch, executive chef Colby Rasavong, and the employees of Bad Idea in East Nashville, congratulating them on their recent recognition as one of the best restaurants in the country and extending our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.